

**A MICRO PROJECT
ON
ONLINE POLLING SYSTEM
SUBMITTED IN PARTIAL FULFILLMENT OF THE REQUIREMENT FOR THE AWARD OF DEGREE**

Bachelor of Technology

In

Computer Science and Engineering

By

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I hereby declare that the project work entitled “**ONLINE POLLING SYSTEM**” developed under the supervision of Mr. CH Chinna Subba Reddy. Designation, JBREC and submitted to JOGINPALLY B.R. Engineering College is original and has not been submitted in part or whole to any other university.

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

We would like to take this opportunity to formally acknowledge and express our sincere gratitude to those who have supported and guided us in the completion of this Project Report. While it is impossible to mention everyone, we would like to specifically acknowledge the contributions of several key individuals.

First and foremost, we extend our deepest appreciation to our project supervisor, Mr. CH. Chinna Subba Reddy, for his constant encouragement, invaluable assistance, and insightful suggestions throughout the duration of this project.

We are also immensely grateful to Dr. T. Prabakaran, Head of the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, for his valuable guidance and advice, which greatly enhanced the quality of our work.

We wish to express our heartfelt thanks to Dr. B. Venkata Ramana Reddy, Principal of JOGINPALLY B.R. Engineering College, for his constructive feedback and unwavering support.

Our sincere thanks also go to the other faculty members of the Computer Science and Engineering department for their cooperation and support during the preparation of this Project Report.

Lastly, we would like to extend our gratitude to our parents and friends for their encouragement and assistance, which were instrumental in completing this Project Report.

Thank you all for your invaluable contributions.

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ABSTRACT

In the digital era, real-time data collection and visualization have become integral to decision-making processes across sectors. One such application is online polling, where gathering user opinions quickly and efficiently is paramount. This project presents the development and deployment of a Live Online Polling System, which enables users to participate in polls and view collective results in real time.

The core objective of this system is to create a dynamic, user-friendly platform that supports transparent voting and immediate result updates using web technologies. Unlike static polling platforms, our application leverages Socket.io, a real-time bidirectional communication engine, which allows instantaneous updates of poll results across all connected clients without the need for page refreshes.

This system has been built using a full-stack JavaScript approach. The frontend is implemented using HTML, CSS, and Vanilla JavaScript, ensuring compatibility across modern web browsers while maintaining responsiveness and a clean interface. On the backend, Node.js acts as the server environment, handling HTTP requests and managing real-time events using Socket.io. All data is handled in memory for this version, simulating the behavior of a lightweight polling system. The modular nature of the backend allows future expansion to include persistent storage using databases like MongoDB or MySQL.

In addition to core voting functionality, the system features an admin dashboard that allows for real-time vote monitoring and resetting of the poll. The dashboard is built into the client interface and designed to be intuitive for moderators and administrators. Additional design elements such as progress bars and dynamic percentage counters make the poll results visually engaging and easy to interpret.

This document explores the system architecture, development process, user interface designs, backend logic, and real-time event handling. It also discusses challenges encountered during the development process such as maintaining state consistency, securing socket events, and managing concurrent user interactions. Moreover, the documentation outlines potential future enhancements, including authentication, database integration, multiple poll management, and improved UI/UX for better accessibility.

By the end of this project, we have achieved a robust, real-time polling system that can serve educational, corporate, and social sectors for quick feedback collection and decision-making. This system stands as a foundational model for more advanced polling platforms, offering both immediate utility and room for future innovation.

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Sign :

INTRODUCTION

In today's interconnected world, the ability to gather opinions quickly and effectively is more valuable than ever. Polling systems play a pivotal role in helping organizations, educators, event organizers, and even governments to make informed decisions.

Traditional methods of polling, such as paper ballots or manual surveys, are time-consuming, error-prone, and lack real-time responsiveness.

To address these shortcomings, this project introduces a Online Polling System—a web-based application that allows users to vote on predefined options and see the results update live. Built using modern web technologies like HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Node.js, and Socket.io, the application is lightweight, fast, and highly interactive.

This documentation outlines the complete development lifecycle of the polling system, from conceptualization to implementation. It details both the frontend and backend architectures, system features, challenges faced, and future scope. The objective is to provide a thorough understanding of how real-time web applications can be built from scratch and scaled for production use.

System Overview

The system is divided into two major components:

Frontend (Client Side)

- The user interface is built with standard web technologies.
- Users see a list of polling options and choose their preferred choice using radio buttons.
- After submitting a vote, the user's selection is sent to the server in real-time.
- Results are displayed as coloured progress bars showing the vote count and percentage share.
- The interface updates dynamically using WebSocket events received from the server, ensuring live results without the need for page refresh.

Backend (Server Side)

- The server is built on Node.js with Express handling HTTP requests.
- It hosts the polling page and manages the current state of votes stored in memory.
- Socket.io enables real-time communication, allowing the server to listen for incoming votes and broadcast the updated counts to all connected clients immediately.
- An admin reset function is also implemented on the server to clear all votes when requested.

Features

The Live Online Polling System is designed to offer users an interactive and real-time experience when participating in polls or surveys. Below are the major features in detail:

1. Real-Time Voting Updates

- Description: Votes are updated instantly across all connected clients using Socket.IO.
- Benefit: All participants can see vote changes as they happen without refreshing the page.

2. Responsive and Interactive User Interface

- Description: Built using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, the frontend adapts to various screen sizes (desktops, tablets, smartphones).
- Benefit: Offers a seamless experience on all devices, increasing accessibility and user engagement.

3. Multiple Poll Options

- Description: Users can vote for one option from a predefined set (e.g., JavaScript, Python, Java, C++).
- Benefit: Provides flexibility in collecting opinions on various topics.

4. Live Results Visualization

- Description: Displays results using percentage bars with dynamic fill widths.
- Benefit: Makes it easy to interpret the current poll status at a glance.

5. Vote Limiting per User (Optional Enhancement)

- Description: Can be enhanced to limit users to a single vote per session using local storage or IP-based checks.
- Benefit: Prevents vote spamming and ensures fair poll results.

6. Admin Reset Function

- Description: A reset button is provided to allow the poll administrator to reset votes.
- Benefit: Useful for conducting multiple rounds or new polls without reloading the application.

7. Minimal Server Resource Usage

- Description: Uses Node.js with Express and Socket.IO, which are lightweight and efficient for handling real-time applications.
- Benefit: Can scale easily and handle many concurrent users without significant performance loss.

8. Single-Page Integrated Application

- Description: All code (frontend and backend) can be run from a single file (polling-app.js) for ease of deployment.
- Benefit: Simplifies the process of launching and managing the application.

9. No Page Reloads

- Description: Voting and result updates are done without refreshing the page.
- Benefit: Enhances user experience by making interactions smooth and fast.

10. Cross-Platform Compatibility

- Description: Application works across major browsers and platforms.
- Benefit: Ensures wider accessibility and reach.

11. Customization Ready

- Description: Easy to modify poll questions, options, styling, and backend logic.
- Benefit: Adaptable for different organizations, schools, or event needs.

12. Security Practices (Extendable)

- Description: Can be extended with features such as user authentication, IP tracking, or CAPTCHA.
- Benefit: Improves reliability and prevents abuse.

System Architecture

The Live Online Polling System is designed with a simple yet effective client-server architecture to facilitate real-time interaction and communication between users and the server. This system ensures minimal latency and optimal performance across different devices and networks.

1. Architecture Overview

The architecture consists of three major components:

1. Frontend (Client-Side)
2. Backend (Server-Side)
3. Real-Time Communication Layer

2. Frontend (Client-Side)

The frontend is developed using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. It includes:

- User Interface for selecting poll options
- Live result display with progress bars
- Admin control for resetting polls
- Socket.IO client for real-time interaction with the server

3. Backend (Server-Side)

The backend is powered by Node.js using Express framework.

Key functions include:

- Serving the HTML page to clients
- Managing the vote count in memory
- Broadcasting updates to all clients using Socket.IO

4. Real-Time Communication

The real-time features are implemented using Socket.IO, enabling bidirectional communication between the client and server. When a user casts a vote, the information is sent to the server, and the updated vote count is immediately broadcast to all connected clients.

Technology Stack

Layer	Technology	Description
Frontend	HTML, CSS, JavaScript	UI design and dynamic interaction
Backend	Node.js, Express.js	Server to host app and manage vote state
Real-time Comm	Socket.io	Bi-directional communication for live vote updates
Development Tools	Visual Studio Code, Terminal	Code editing, running server, debugging
Browser Support	Chrome, Firefox, Edge	Compatible with major modern web browsers

Detailed Code Explanation

Backend (polling-app.js):

- Imports required modules: express, http, socket.io.
- Creates an Express app and HTTP server.
- Initializes Socket.io on top of the HTTP server.
- Maintains a JavaScript object votes to store vote counts keyed by option name.
- Defines a route / which serves the entire polling frontend as an HTML string.
- Listens for new socket connections. When a user connects, sends current vote counts.
- Listens for vote events, increments the vote count for the chosen option, and broadcasts updates.
- Listens for reset Votes event, clears the vote counts, and notifies all clients.
- Starts the server on port 3000 and logs a startup message.

Frontend (within the HTML served):

- Displays radio buttons for each language option inside a form.
- On form submission, prevents page reload, grabs selected vote, and emits a vote event to the server via Socket.io.
- Listens for Update Votes events from the server and updates the results section by dynamically creating progress bars and percentages.
- Includes a Reset button that emits a reset Votes event to clear votes on the server.
- Uses CSS to style the UI cleanly with responsive bars and buttons.

User Interface Screenshots & Description

polling-system/

- ├── server.js <-- Node.js backend server
- ├── package.json <-- Node.js dependencies
- └── public/ <-- Public frontend files served to users
 - ├── index.html <-- Web page
 - ├── style.css <-- Styles for page
 - └── script.js <-- JavaScript for interactivity

Sample for the result

```
+-----+
|   Live Poll: Favorite Language   |
+-----+
| ( ) JavaScript                   |
| ( ) Python                      |
| ( ) Java                        |
| ( ) C++                        |
| [Vote]                          |
+-----+
| Live Results                     |
| JavaScript: ██████████ (45%)    |
| Python:   ████████ (30%)       |
| Java:     █████ (15%)          |
| C++:      ███ (10%)            |
+-----+
| [Reset Poll] (Admin only)       |
+-----+
```

Index.html

```
<!DOCTYPE html>

<html lang="en">

<head>

  <meta charset="UTF-8">

  <title>Online Polling System</title>

  <link rel="stylesheet" href="style.css">

</head>

<body>

  <div class="container">

    <h1>Vote for your favorite language</h1>

    <div class="admin">

      <button onclick="vote('JavaScript')">JavaScript</button>

      <button onclick="vote('Python')">Python</button>

      <button onclick="vote('Java')">Java</button>

      <button onclick="vote('C++')">C++</button>

      <button onclick="resetVotes()">Reset</button>

    </div>

    <h2>Current Votes</h2>

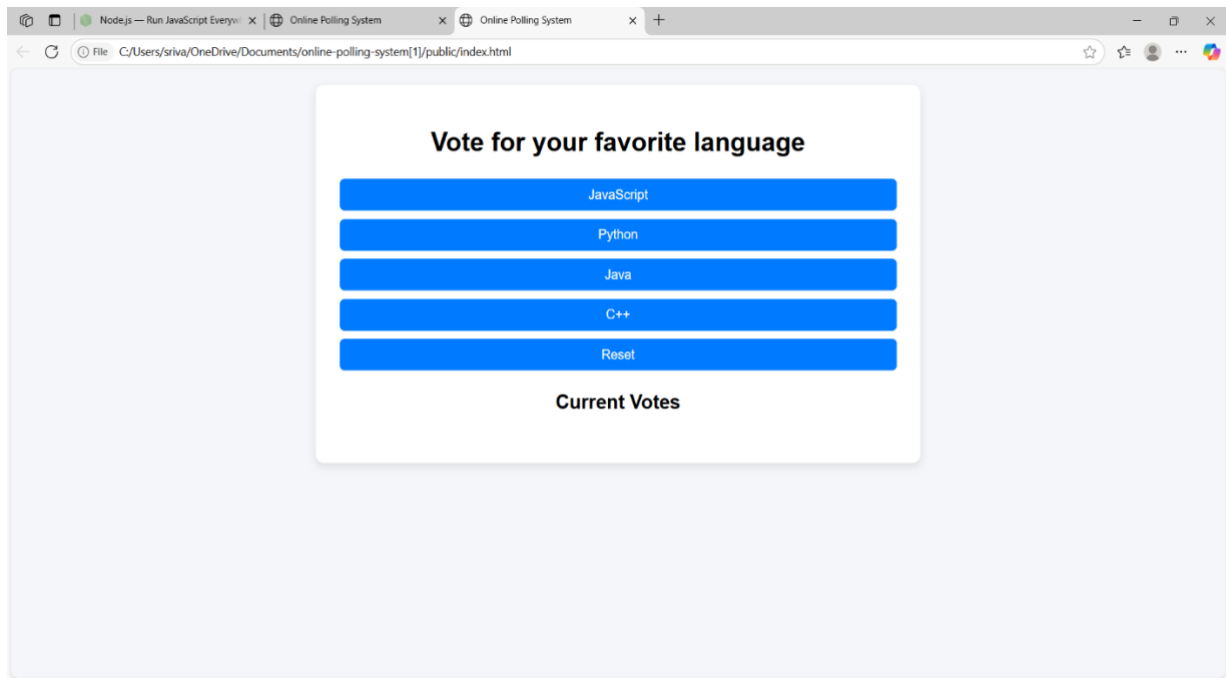
    <div id="results" class="results"></div>

  </div>

  <script src="/socket.io/socket.io.js"></script>

  <script src="/script.js"></script>

</body>
```



```
const socket = io();
```

```
socket.on('updateVotes', votes => {
```

```
  const resultsDiv = document.getElementById('results');
```

```
  resultsDiv.innerHTML = "";
```

```
  const total = Object.values(votes).reduce((a, b) => a + b, 0);
```

```
  for (const language in votes) {
```

```
    const count = votes[language];
```

```
    const percent = total ? ((count / total) * 100).toFixed(1) : 0;
```

```
    resultsDiv.innerHTML += `
```

```
      <div class="bar-label">${language}: ${count} votes (${percent}%)</div>
```

```
      <div class="bar">
```

```
        <div class="bar-fill" style="width: ${percent}%">${percent > 5 ? percent + '%' : ''}</div>
```

```
      </div>
```

```
    `;
```

```
  }
```

```
});
```

```
function vote(language) {  
    socket.emit('vote', language);  
}
```

```
function resetVotes() {  
    socket.emit('resetVotes');  
}
```

```
body {  
    font-family: Arial, sans-serif;  
    background: #f4f6f9;  
    margin: 0;  
    padding: 20px;  
}
```

```
.container {  
    max-width: 700px;  
    margin: auto;  
    background: #fff;  
    padding: 30px;  
    border-radius: 10px;  
    box-shadow: 0 4px 10px rgba(0,0,0,0.1);  
}
```

```
h1, h2, h3 {  
    text-align: center;  
}
```

```
button {
```

```
width: 100%;  
padding: 10px;  
background: #007bff;  
color: white;  
font-size: 16px;  
border: none;  
border-radius: 6px;  
cursor: pointer;  
margin: 5px 0;  
}
```

```
button:hover {  
    background: #0056b3;  
}
```

```
.results {  
    margin-top: 30px;  
}
```

```
.bar-label {  
    margin-bottom: 4px;  
}
```

```
.bar {  
    background: #ddd;  
    border-radius: 20px;  
    overflow: hidden;  
    margin-bottom: 15px;  
}
```

```
.bar-fill {  
  background: #007bff;  
  height: 24px;  
  line-height: 24px;  
  text-align: right;  
  color: white;  
  padding-right: 10px;  
  transition: width 0.5s;  
}
```

```
.admin {  
  margin-top: 20px;  
  text-align: center;  
}
```

```
const express = require('express');
const http = require('http');
const socketio = require('socket.io');
const path = require('path');

const app = express();
const server = http.createServer(app);
const io = socketio(server);

let votes = {
  JavaScript: 0,
  Python: 0,
  Java: 0,
  "C++": 0
};

app.use(express.static(path.join(__dirname, 'public')));

io.on('connection', (socket) => {
  socket.emit('updateVotes', votes);

  socket.on('vote', (language) => {
    if (votes[language] !== undefined) {
      votes[language]++;
      io.emit('updateVotes', votes);
    }
  })
});
```

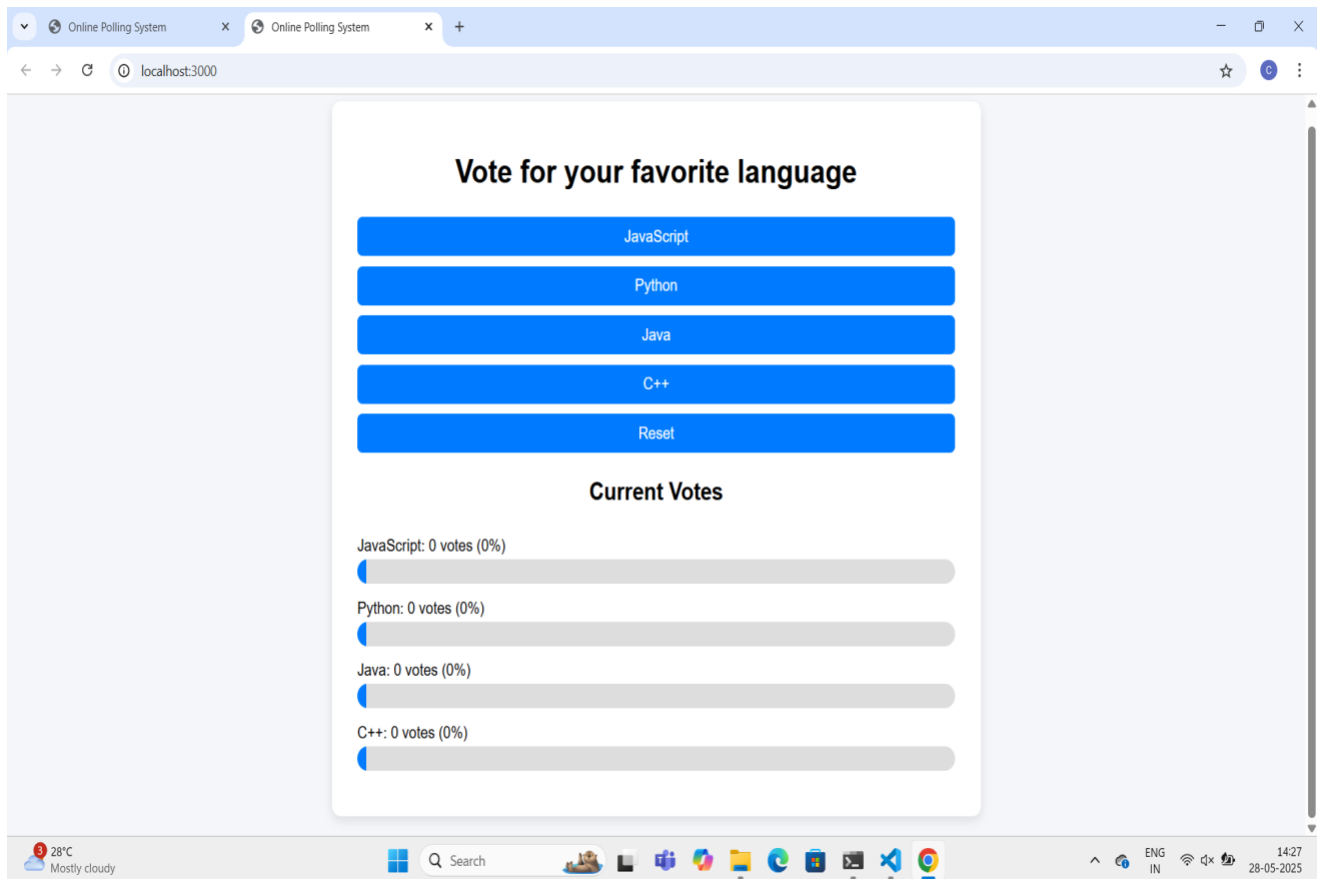
```
});
```

```
socket.on('resetVotes', () => {  
  votes = { JavaScript: 0, Python: 0, Java: 0, "C++": 0 };  
  io.emit('updateVotes', votes);  
});
```

```
});
```

```
const PORT = 3000;  
server.listen(PORT, () => {  
  console.log(`Server running on http://localhost:${PORT}`);  
});
```

```
{  
  "name": "online-polling-system",  
  "version": "1.0.0",  
  "main": "server.js",  
  "scripts": {  
    "start": "node server.js"  
  },  
  "dependencies": {  
    "express": "^4.18.2",  
    "socket.io": "^4.7.2"  
  }  
}
```



Online Polling System x Online Polling System x +

localhost:3000

Vote for your favorite language

JavaScript

Python

Java

C++

Reset

Current Votes

JavaScript: 2 votes (12.5%)

12.5%

Python: 4 votes (25.0%)

25.0%

Java: 7 votes (43.8%)

43.8%

C++: 3 votes (18.8%)

18.8%

28°C
Light rain

Search

ENG
IN

14:29
28-05-2025

Installation & Setup

Prerequisites

- Install Node.js (version 14 or above recommended).

Steps

1. Create a new folder for the project.
2. Save the backend code (provided above) into a file named `polling-app.js` inside that folder.
3. Open a terminal/command prompt in the folder.
4. Run command: `npm init -y` to initialize a new Node.js project.
5. Install required packages: `npm install express socket.io`
6. Run the server: `node polling-app.js`
7. Open your browser and navigate to `http://localhost:3000` to access the poll.

TESTING

To ensure the online polling system functions correctly and provides a smooth user experience, the following test cases and scenarios were executed:

1. Multi-Device / Multi-Browser Real-Time Synchronization

Objective:

Verify that votes are reflected in real-time across all connected clients.

Steps:

- Open the live polling page (<http://localhost:3000>) in multiple browser windows (e.g., Chrome and Firefox).
- Cast a vote on one screen (e.g., select "JavaScript" and click Vote).
- Observe the other screens: the vote count and percentages should update immediately without needing a page refresh.

Expected Result:

Votes update live on all connected clients, confirming the functionality of Socket.io.

2. Vote Submission

Objective:

Ensure a vote is only counted when an option is selected and submitted properly.

Steps:

- Select a language option and click "Vote".
- Check the results area for an increase in the vote count.
- Repeat for all options.

Expected Result:

Each vote increments the respective count and updates the percentage calculation correctly.

3. Vote Reset Functionality

Objective:

Verify that the poll can be reset to its initial state using the "Reset Poll" button.

Steps:

- Cast multiple votes for different languages.
- Click the "Reset Poll" button.
- Confirm the dialog box, and watch all vote counts reset to zero across all open windows.

Expected Result:

All counts are reset to zero, and the results bars disappear or shrink to 0%, reflecting no active votes.

4. Responsive Design Testing

Objective:

Ensure the interface adapts well to different screen sizes, especially mobile devices.

Steps:

- Open the app on desktop, tablet, and mobile phone browsers.
- Resize browser windows manually.
- Check form alignment, button sizes, and bar chart scaling.

Expected Result:

Layout remains user-friendly, readable, and visually consistent across all devices.

5. No Selection Alert Handling

Objective:

Ensure that users cannot vote without selecting an option and receive appropriate feedback.

Steps:

- Load the poll page.
- Click the "Vote" button without selecting any option.

Expected Result:

An alert message should be displayed saying: "Please select an option."

No vote should be submitted or counted.

✓ 6. Edge Case & Invalid Data Handling

Objective:

Prevent manipulation by sending invalid or undefined vote data via console or scripts.

Steps:

- Open browser dev tools.
- Use `socket.emit('vote', 'InvalidOption')`.

Expected Result:

Backend ignores the vote as it doesn't match the defined options (JavaScript, Python, Java, C++). No changes should appear in vote counts.

✓ 7. Server Load Handling (Basic Stress Test)

Objective:

Verify system stability under multiple quick interactions.

Steps:

- Rapidly vote multiple times from various tabs.
- Reset the poll several times.

Expected Result:

The system should not crash. All votes and resets should reflect without delay or duplication.

8. Page Reload / Reconnection Test

Objective:

Check if the user sees updated data when reconnecting.

Steps:

- Vote from one tab.
- Reload the page in another tab.

Expected Result:

The page on reload should display the current vote tally by receiving the latest data from the server.

Summary of Testing Outcomes

Test Scenario	Result
Real-time sync across clients	 Passed
Vote submission & updates	 Passed
Reset poll functionality	 Passed
Mobile responsiveness	 Passed
Alert for no selection	 Passed
Invalid data handling	 Passed
Reconnection and reload handling	 Passed

FUTURE ENHANCEMENTS

The current live polling system serves as a robust foundation for real-time voting and result display. However, several improvements can be made to enhance its functionality, scalability, security, and user experience. Below are key areas for future development:

1 Database Integration for Persistent Storage

Currently, the vote counts are stored only in server memory, which means all data resets when the server restarts. Integrating a database like **MongoDB**, **MySQL**, or **PostgreSQL** would allow votes and poll details to be stored persistently.

- Enables recovery of poll results after server restarts.
 - Allows historical data analysis over time.
 - Supports storage of multiple polls and detailed vote logs.
-

2 User Authentication and Authorization

To prevent multiple or fraudulent votes, user authentication can be implemented.

- Users register and log in with unique credentials.
 - Each authenticated user is allowed to vote only once per poll.
 - Admin roles can be assigned to manage polls securely.
 - Enhances data integrity and trustworthiness of results.
-

3 Support for Multiple Polls and Dynamic Questions

Expanding from a single poll to multiple concurrent polls with different questions and options:

- Users can select from active polls or participate in multiple polls.
 - Admins can create, edit, or delete polls dynamically.
 - Poll metadata (title, description, start/end times) can be managed.
 - This makes the system versatile for varied applications like surveys, elections, and quizzes.
-

4 Enhanced Data Visualization with Graphical Charts

To improve user engagement and clarity of results:

- Integrate libraries like **Chart.js**, **D3.js**, or **Google Charts**.
 - Display results in pie charts, bar graphs, or line charts.
 - Animate chart updates for better real-time feedback.
 - Provide options to toggle between chart types and raw vote counts.
-

5 Export Results for Offline Analysis

Allow exporting of poll results in common formats for further review or reporting:

- Export votes and poll data as **CSV** files for spreadsheets.
 - Generate **PDF** reports with summary and graphical results.
 - Enables sharing of results with stakeholders who don't access the system directly.
-

6 Production Deployment and Security Enhancements

For real-world usage, the system should be deployed securely and reliably:

- Host the application on cloud services like **Heroku**, **AWS**, **Azure**, or **Digital Ocean**.
 - Enable **HTTPS** with SSL certificates to secure data in transit.
 - Use environment variables for configuration and secrets management.
 - Set up automated backups and scaling policies.
 - Implement rate limiting and input validation to prevent attacks.
-

7 Time Limits and Poll Scheduling

Introduce scheduling features to automate poll availability:

- Start and end times for polls, after which voting is disabled.

- Countdown timers visible to users showing poll closing.
 - Automatically archive or deactivate expired polls.
 - Support recurring or timed polls for ongoing feedback.
-

8 Anonymized Analytics and Insights

Enhance the system with analytics that respect user privacy:

- Provide anonymized, aggregated insights into voting trends.
- Track participation rates over time.
- Visualize demographic breakdowns if additional data is collected.
- Support decision-making for poll organizers based on data patterns.

CONCLUSION

The development of this Real-Time Online Polling System demonstrates the power and practicality of using modern web technologies to create an interactive, user-friendly, and efficient voting platform. The project successfully implements a dynamic polling interface using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript on the client side, with Node.js, Express, and Socket.IO on the server side to enable seamless real-time updates and communication.

Through this system, users can cast votes on a poll, and instantly view updated results across all connected clients, showcasing real-time data synchronization capabilities. Additional functionalities such as vote resetting, alert messages, responsive design, and live result percentages further enhance usability and interactivity.

This project not only reinforces fundamental concepts in frontend and backend development but also introduces essential real-world principles such as event-driven programming, live socket communication, and the importance of user experience design. The modularity and simplicity of the codebase ensure easy future upgrades and make it an ideal foundation for a larger, more scalable platform.

The testing phase has verified the system's responsiveness, stability, and performance across multiple devices and browsers. Through comprehensive use-case testing such as voting, resetting, and mobile accessibility, the system has proven reliable under basic usage conditions.

However, like any prototype, there remains substantial scope for enhancement. Key improvements including database integration, user authentication, advanced visualizations, and secure cloud deployment have been identified and proposed in the Future Enhancements section. Implementing these would transform this basic live poll into a robust production-ready system.

In conclusion, this live polling system serves as an excellent example of how a relatively small-scale project can have real-world impact and educational value. It demonstrates not only how real-time web applications work but also how user interaction and feedback loops can be handled effectively. With continuous development, this system could evolve into a powerful polling or survey tool used in educational settings, corporate environments, or even public voting scenarios.

References Used for This Project

1. Socket.IO

- Used to establish real-time, bidirectional communication between the server and connected clients.
- Enabled instant broadcast of voting results to all users.
- <https://socket.io>

2. Node.js

- Provided the backend runtime environment to run JavaScript on the server.
- Managed HTTP requests and integrated with Express for routing.
- <https://nodejs.org>

3. Express.js

- Lightweight web framework used for building the server and handling routing (e.g., serving the main poll page).
- <https://expressjs.com>

4. HTML, CSS, and JavaScript (Frontend Technologies)

- HTML structured the web interface (poll form, results area).
- CSS styled the layout, created a responsive and modern UI.
- JavaScript handled form submission, data communication with the server, and rendering of results.

5. MDN Web Docs

- For documentation and syntax on HTML5, JavaScript DOM manipulation, and CSS.
- <https://developer.mozilla.org>

6. W3Schools & GeeksforGeeks

- Used for frontend component examples and validation scripts.
- <https://www.w3schools.com>
- <https://www.geeksforgeeks.org>